

**UNITED STATES OF AMERICA
BEFORE THE
FEDERAL ENERGY REGULATORY COMMISSION**

**Interconnection of Large Loads to the
Interstate Transmission System**

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Docket No. RM26-4-000

INITIAL COMMENTS OF BASE POWER COMPANY, INC.

In response to the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission’s (the “Commission”) notice dated October 27, 2025, and November 7, 2025, Base Power Company (“Base Power”) provides the following initial comments on the Advance Notice of Proposed Rulemaking (the “ANOPR”) on large load interconnection released by the Secretary of Energy, *Interconnection of Large Loads to the Interstate Transmission Sys.*, Advanced Notice of Proposed Rulemaking, Docket No. RM26-4-000. Base Power develops, installs, owns and operates utility-grade dispatchable energy systems that participate in wholesale markets and deliver capacity to customers in regulated and deregulated energy markets. Our experience as a resource owner and operator, electricity supplier, and load-serving entity, managing both load and generating capacity at shared points of interconnection in real time, provides a practical perspective on how new interconnection frameworks can facilitate and accelerate interconnection for critical large loads, ensuring the U.S. maintains technical leadership in AI and achieves energy dominance.

Executive Summary

As the Secretary of Energy has emphasized, the unprecedented pace of new large load interconnections necessitates standardized interconnection procedures and agreements to enable timely, orderly, and non-discriminatory access to the transmission system. Base Power supports the Commission’s efforts to advance this objective and proposes three principles for the Commission’s consideration:

- I. **Dispatchable load must become ubiquitously contractible.** Dispatchable, meaning the precise, at-will control of the range of net power injection or withdrawal, generation *and* load should be

equally contractible commodities. In particular, for hybrid sites constituting a mix of generation and load resources behind a point of interconnection, the total range of dispatchable capacity should be a measurable and performance-based commodity that can be procured, scheduled, compensated, and held to emergency operating conditions much like traditional generating capacity.

- II. **New load-enabling generation siting constraints should allow for electrically proximal resources.** Siting for dispatchable capacity additions in service of new loads should remain open to both those behind the same *and* electrically proximal points of interconnection on the bulk transmission system, reflecting the functional reality that location does not diminish reliability value when performance is verifiable.
- III. **Dispatchability and load-impact-mitigating generation combined should expedite interconnection study.** The Commission should encourage mechanisms, such as expedited interconnection, to incentivize voluntary participation by large loads that choose to make their operations available as dispatchable system assets or facilitate the deployment of net new dispatchable capacity resources to *reliably and economically* serve system needs. When the proposed load itself is verifiably dispatchable, *system reliability* is maintained. When new load is combined with net new generation capacity and/or dispatchable resources that increase the total energy output of the system, *resource adequacy* is achieved more economically, to the benefit of the rate base.

Together these principles support a durable framework that enhances reliability, improves efficiency, and leverages existing infrastructure to meet emerging system needs.

Comments

I. Dispatchable load must become contractible

Curtailable load and/or dispatchable hybrid facilities (herein referred to collectively as ‘dispatchable resources’ or ‘dispatchability’) must be implemented as defined, contractible commodities in order to be sufficiently integrated into both operations and system planning, with respect to large load interconnection processes. Base Power encourages the Commission to contemplate regulatory frameworks that establish a “structured, transactional approach” to dispatchability, such as the “large load [dispatchability] commitment” presented in a recent issue brief¹. In this way, *dispatchable load and generation resources* can be designed and maximally leveraged to provide resource adequacy benefits, transmission system benefits, or a combination thereof.

In this context, dispatchability refers to a defined and enforceable commitment by a load or hybrid facility to modulate its demand to a specific power at a specific rate, or mitigate its system impact through dispatchable hybrid resources, under specific conditions in exchange for recognized system and market value. To be contractible, particularly for dispatchable load, the conditions for operation must be clearly delimited and well-defined, with established parameters for availability and performance requirements (e.g., ramp rate and target power error tolerances). These parameters allow dispatchability to function as a measurable capacity product, enabling operators to plan around a known performance envelope rather than a discretionary response. Such parameters also ensure that the dispatchability provided has quantifiable reliability value, in accordance with established performance criteria, and provide the basis for enforcement, verification and settlement.

¹ Walsh, S., M. Farmer, A. Zevin, K. Smaczniak, G. Daly, N. Lobel, A. Clements, Y. Guo, and T. Profeta. 2025. How DOE’s Proposed Large Load Interconnection Process Could Unlock the Benefits of Load Flexibility. NI PB 25-03. Durham, NC: Nicholas Institute for Energy, Environment & Sustainability, Duke University. <https://nicholasinstitute.duke.edu/publications/how-doesproposed-large-load-interconnection-process-could-unlock-benefits>.

We draw the Commission’s attention to the definition² of Controllable Load Resources (CLR) enabled in ERCOT – a CLR is defined as a “*Load Resource capable of controllably reducing or increasing consumption under Dispatch control by ERCOT*”. ERCOT nodal protocols 6.6.5.1.1 details acceptable performance criterion for loads participating in economic dispatch processes. Performance metrics establish acceptable tolerances for frequency response and deviation from target power and ramp rates. Importantly, these loads meeting their resource qualification requirements does not jeopardize resource adequacy, as strict performance criterion applies directly to dispatchable resources. Comparatively, a firm load must be assumed to be drawing maximum load for each of a long list of contingent scenarios a balancing authority may face because the load cannot be assumed to be responsive to dispatch signals. Thus, impacts to binding congestion constraints or transient deviations in frequency are by default exacerbated by the introduction of this load to a model of the systems power flow when considered for interconnection.

Proposed Properties of Dispatchable Load

A dispatchable load resource should attain the following properties:

1. The load has a controllable range of withdrawal (or injection if inclusive of hybrid sites capable of net power generation at the point of interconnection).
2. Within this controllable range, the load is responsive to economic dispatch signals from balancing authorities.
3. Within this controllable range, a dispatchable load can ramp and maintain specific power setpoints inside operationally useful error tolerances.
4. Within this controllable range, a dispatchable load has a defined frequency response curve.
5. A dispatchable load has otherwise defined fault tolerance characteristics (e.g. voltage ride-through) such that contingencies can be sufficiently modeled.

² Electric Reliability Council of Texas (ERCOT), *ERCOT Nodal Protocols*, September 1, 2025, § 2, p. 91.

Exhibit A³, appended to this filing, illustrates how the CLR resources in ERCOT attain these proposed properties and specific parameter values used, and Section 2.3 of the ERCOT Controllable Load Qualification Test Procedure⁴ demonstrates how information like frequency response characteristics are communicated to the balancing authority for verification and qualification. These properties inform the core assumptions made when a new load is studied for interconnection – allowing it to be sufficiently modeled, and integrated into system planning and operations. Key to this: a dispatchable load is not assumed to be firm and operating at an extreme system state when its impact to infrequent system contingencies are analyzed.

Importantly, how the dispatched power is achieved at the point of interconnection is less important than the market-enforced adherence to performance criteria, such that said capacity is reliably contractible. A load, together with colocated or proximal dispatchable generation or storage can combine as a hybrid resource to achieve a net power at the point of interconnection with specific minimum and maximum capabilities and expected response rates established by a balancing authority, similar to the parameters specified for CLR in ERCOT.

II. New load-enabling generation siting constraints should allow for electrically proximal resources.

Base Power encourages the Commission to recognize that resource adequacy is not unilaterally bound by the physical location of the asset providing it. Resources capable of modulating their consumption or

³ Electric Reliability Council of Texas (ERCOT). *CLREDP Acceptable Performance Criteria and PRC*. EMIL ID NP8-114-M, Rule NP8.1.1.4.1(10), <https://www.ercot.com/mp/data-products/data-product-details?id=NP8-114-M>.

⁴ Electric Reliability Council of Texas (ERCOT). *Controllable Load Qualification Test Procedure for Ancillary Services*, Sec. 2.3, stating: “All CLRs are required to respond to changes to their Load anytime the frequency at the CLR exceeds their deadband of ± 0.036 HZ and are required to do a self-test as prescribed by the Operating Guide Section 8(C). The test results should be documented on the form in that same section of the Operating Guides and then submitted to the NDCRC application. The results of this test will also be used to calculate the droop characteristics for the CLR, and the limits applied in the model for the % limit of their HSL/MPC for RRS.” https://www.ercot.com/files/docs/2024/08/30/24_0827-controllable_load_qualification_test_procedure_for_ancillary_services_ver_3_1_sk2.docx

injection of power in response to system needs on demand, whether located at the load site or elsewhere on the system, offer functionally identical value to reliability and grid stability where modeled and verified in the course of typical, day-to-day grid operating conditions. The defining feature of resource adequacy is dispatchability, not geography. A resource that can increase or decrease its output or load in response to an operator signal provides the same system benefit whether it is co-located with the facility it serves or operates under a contractual arrangement elsewhere. Therefore, constraining generation in service of supporting new load interconnection dispatchability to a narrow class of assets would unnecessarily exclude a significant portion of capacity already supporting grid operation.

The Southwest Power Pool's (SPP) recent High Impact Large Load (HILL) filing⁴ before the Commission provides a current and concrete example of how regional operators are already treating dispatchability as a system reliability concept rather than a fixed interconnection category. In that filing, SPP proposed Tariff Attachments BA and BB to create new study and operational frameworks for HILLs and for "High Impact Large Load Generation Assessments" (HILLGA). Under the HILLGA process, supplemental generating facilities procured to serve such loads may be considered in a combined application with the load, expediting interconnection, when located electrically proximal, defined as no more than two bulk-system substations away from the load.

Importantly, the HILLGA model expands opportunities for large loads to contribute to resource adequacy in a manner that is more cost-effective to the rate base than relying solely on load curtailment. SPP's proposal recognizes that, in the course of normal grid operations, it is far less expensive and far more reliable to meet incremental resource adequacy needs with supplemental generation, whether located on-site or electrical proximal, than to compensate a large load for curtailing during tight but otherwise

⁴ Southwest Power Pool, Inc., *Submission of Tariff Revisions to Add the High Impact Large Load Processes and High Impact Large Load Generation Assessment*, Docket No. ER26-264-000 (FERC filed October 24, 2025) proposing "Load Limited Resource Interconnection Service" for generation located within two substations of a High Impact Large Load.

non-emergency or contingent system conditions. Load curtailment is inherently non-firm and typically requires comparatively costly compensation, while other forms of dispatchable generation can provide predictable, verifiable output that is directly incorporated into forward-looking reliability models. As SPP asserts, the HILL and “local area” framework improves “market efficiency”, “cost-effectiveness”, and “confidence in expected costs and timelines”. These concepts reflect the reality that adding dispatchable resources is a cost-efficient, expeditious and more reliable resource adequacy solution than treating largeload curtailment as the marginal resource. By contrast, emergency price response cannot satisfy Commission-approved planning criteria because its performance is neither firm nor modelable.

Committed dispatchable capability, as recognized in SPP’s HILLGA filing, can be included in operational assumptions to improve study accuracy and support more efficient system operations. The HILLGA framework confirms this approach by allowing contingent or supporting generation to be considered alongside the load, acknowledging that resource adequacy can be delivered more economically, through dedicated dispatchable resources, than through high-cost curtailment alone. This treatment mirrors Base Power’s position that dispatchable capability can be provided by proximal, verifiable resources capable of delivering predictable system response, including customer-sited or aggregated technologies.

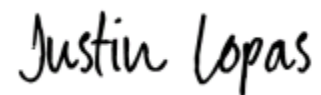
The Point of Interconnection (POI) remains the essential reference for determining how facilities are studied, monitored, and integrated into system operations. However, as SPP’s HILL proposal illustrates, reliability impacts and operational dispatchability are not confined to the single load-interconnected POI itself. Dispatchable assets located near or electrically proximal to a load, whether sharing the same POI or connected within a limited local area, can materially affect flows, voltage stability, and balancing requirements at the node. Maintaining an open approach to dispatchability allows system operators to evaluate such resources in relation to their effect on the POI, rather than by strict interconnection topology. This ensures that operationally relevant capacity, whether physically co-located with the load or situated a few substations away, can be considered within interconnection and planning studies, consistent with the localized assessment structure already proposed by SPP.

III. Dispatchability and load-impact-mitigating generation combined should expedite interconnection

Principle Seven in Secretary Wright’s letter⁵ to the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission asserts that “large loads...and hybrid facilities that agree to be curtailable and dispatchable should be expedited.”

Base Power concurs that establishing clear incentives for dispatchable performance is an appropriate and effective means of enhancing system reliability. Structuring expedited interconnection pathways around voluntary “dispatchability commitments” creates a measurable reliability benefit and helps ensure that study assumptions more accurately reflect actual system behavior. Base Power defers to large-load stakeholders on the appropriate sequencing of studies, whether serial or otherwise structured, and on the operationally reasonable timelines for processing such studies. Our position is limited to the principle that interconnection frameworks should reflect verifiable system responsiveness and align procedural efficiencies with demonstrated dispatchability, thereby improving study accuracy, reducing unnecessary system upgrades, and supporting product grid planning.

Respectfully Submitted,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Justin Lopas". The signature is written in a cursive, slightly slanted style.

Justin Lopas
COO, Base Power Company

⁵ Advance Notice of Proposed Rulemaking, *Ensuring the Timely and Orderly Interconnection of Large Loads*, at 12 (attached to Secretary of Energy’s Oct. 23, 2025 letter issued under DOE Organization Act § 403).

Exhibit A

The following comments were filed and approved by TAC at its 9/5/2013 meeting and are documented in the filing for NPRR 532/555.

These values will be updated upon a change that is presented and approved by TAC.

Comments

(1) NPRR532, which is proceeding through the stakeholder process, proposes revisions in Sections 3.9.1, 6.5.5.2, 6.5.7.6.2.3 and 8.1.1.4.3 that are relevant to the consideration of this NPRR. The revisions proposed in NPRR532 are shown below with the author "NPRR532."

(2) At the 9/5/13 TAC meeting, TAC endorsed the following PRS recommendations regarding values for the X and Y variables relative to Base Point Deviation Charges and CLREDP:

Resource/Metric	Protocol Reference (\$)	X (%)	Y (MW)
Base Point Deviation, Over-Consumption, Controllable Load Resource	6.6.5.1.1.3	25	2
Base Point Deviation, Under-Consumption, Controllable Load Resource	6.6.5.1.1.4	15	2
Base Point Deviation, Over-Consumption, Controllable Load Resource with Ancillary Service responsibility	6.6.5.1.1.3	15	2
Base Point Deviation, Under-Consumption, Controllable Load Resource with Ancillary Service Responsibility	6.6.5.1.1.4	10	2
CLREDP	8.1.1.4.1(9)	25	2
CLREDP with Ancillary Service Responsibility	8.1.1.4.1(9)	15	2

TAC also endorsed the following PRS recommendations regarding values for the X and Y variables relative to ALR telemetry validation contained in the related Other Binding Document, "Requirements for Aggregate Load Resource Participation in the ERCOT Markets":

Resource/Metric	X (%)	Y (%)	Description
ALR Telemetry Validation, Monthly Net Power Flow vs. Meter Data	90	10	X% of telemetry values within Y% of meter data
ALR Telemetry Validation, SPC+2 Qualification (for Ancillary Service)	80	10	X% of SPC+2 values within Y% of NPF values
ALR Telemetry Validation, Monthly SPC+2 vs. SPC (for Ancillary Service)	80	10	X% of SPC+2 values within Y% of SPC values
ALR Telemetry Validation during SCED Deployments	n/a	10	Y% difference between ERCOT baseline and SPC/SPC+2 values